NETHERBLOOM

Book of Remembrance



Child of the Last Flame

The old grave-texts told the dead: do not drink from Lethe; find the spring of Memory. This Book is that spring.

THE SOUL OF THIS BOOK

Child of the Last Flame

One more little light, struck against the cold.

The snow came down on the last night of the year as if it meant to bury the town. In a doorway between two tall houses, out of the wind but not out of the cold, a girl sat with her bare feet tucked under her and a bundle of little lights in her lap. She had walked the streets since noon calling them out. No one had bought a single one, and she did not dare go home with the bundle still full.

Through a frosted window across the street she could see a kitchen: a stove glowing orange, a table laid for a feast, a goose browning in its own steam. From somewhere further down came the smell of roast apples, from a house that was not hers. She had been hungry so long that the hunger had stopped hurting and become a kind of weight, pressing her into the step.

She struck one light to warm her fingers. For as long as it burned the doorway was gone, and she sat beside a great iron stove. It went out, and the cold came back worse. She struck another, and another. In each flame there was something she had wanted: the stove, the feast, a tree hung with a thousand candles. And in the last flame, the one she had saved, there was the one who used to hold her before she was gone, her grandmother, holding out her arms and saying it was time to come home.

In the morning they found her in the doorway, smiling, with a handful of burnt-out ends. The old ferryman would not carry her; she had no coin, only cinders. So she came to you. She is small and very tired, and she still has a few lights left. Walk slowly with her. She has never been anywhere warm.



What the Ferrymen know

She came to the river already carrying light, so her crossing begins with three. Her small flames shield her: the first crack in each Reach does not touch her. She has never wandered in her life; she waits where she is told, and is never Adrift. She has lost so much already that she can let one more memory go before she Fades. And the harshest Mists will not come near a child.

Twist: Starts with 3 Light. The first Fracture in each Reach is ignored. Never drifts Adrift. She can forget 1 more card before she Fades. No harsh Mist.

Key Memory: *the one who used to hold me before she was gone*



Keeping the Book

The Book has one page per Reach. Each page has four slots, **Place**, **Person**, **Deed** and **Feeling**, which fill a sentence about the soul's life.

You may **inscribe** a card when it Resonates, if its memory's slot is still empty on the current page. A **Key Memory** card may be inscribed whenever it is played face up. An inscribed card leaves the deck for good: you trade a useful card for a memory the soul will keep.

Chapter Blessing. When a page holds 3 memories (2 for the Garland Girl), the river grants the first of these that applies: mend a Fracture, drain Black Water, or return a forgotten card.

At the end, the Book is read aloud. Slots never filled read "...but this, the river has taken".

Tuck an inscribed card into the well for its slot: slide its four corners under the slits. Slide it out again to reuse the card next game.

I · Who I Was

I was born near...

PLACE

...but this, the river has taken

I loved...

PERSON

...but this, the river has taken

I once...

DEED

...but this, the river has taken

and ever since I have carried...

FEELING

...but this, the river has taken

☐ Chapter Blessing

Keepsakes ☐ ☐ ☐

II · What I Did

At...

PLACE

...but this, the river has taken

before...



PERSON

...but this, the river has taken

I...



DEED

...but this, the river has taken

The price was...



FEELING

...but this, the river has taken

☐ Chapter Blessing

Keepsakes ☐ ☐ ☐

III · What I Carry

I go now, leaving...



forgiving...



unable to undo the day I...



holding only...



☐ Chapter Blessing

Keepsakes ☐ ☐ ☐

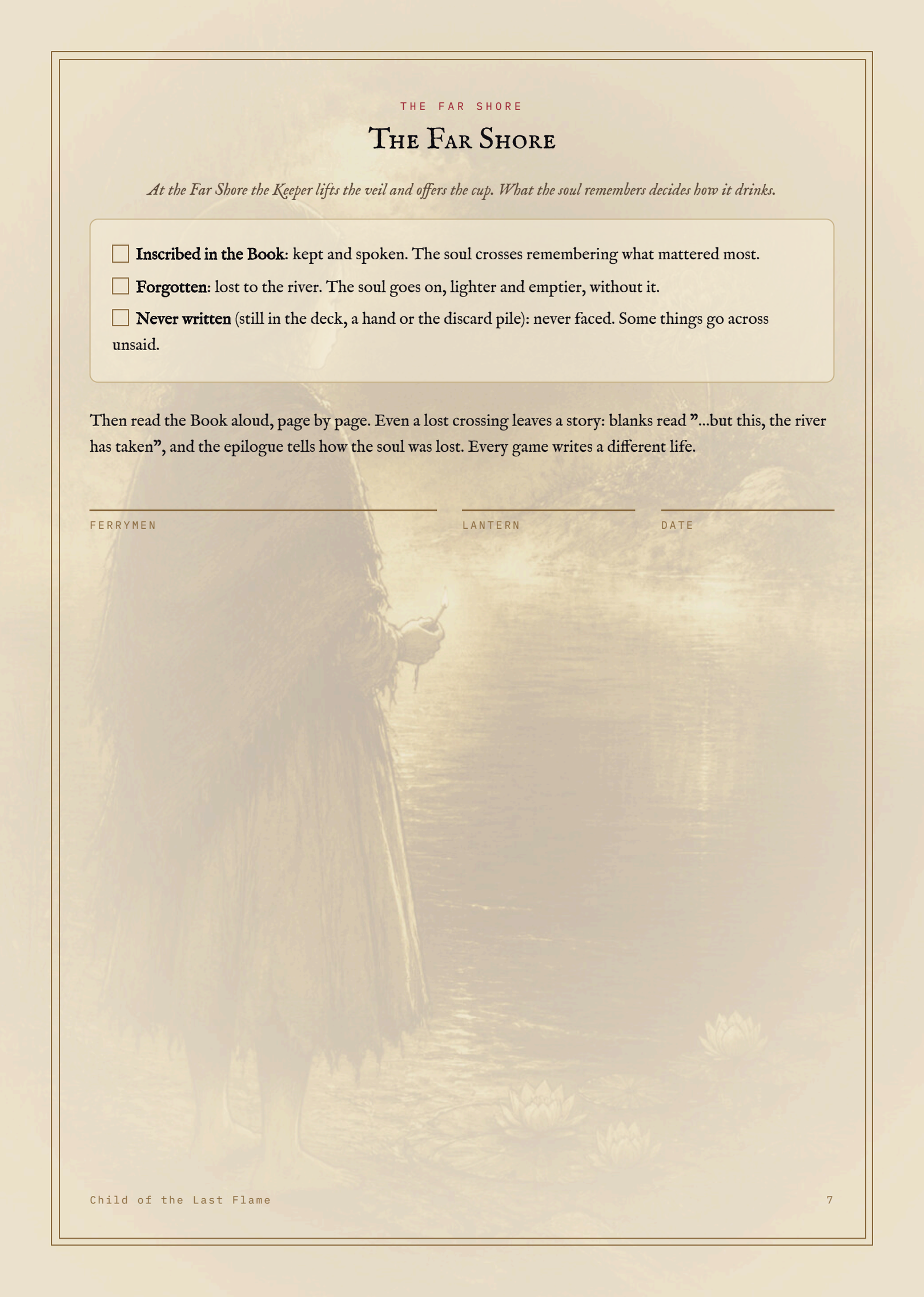
The Far Shore

At the Far Shore the Keeper lifts the veil and offers the cup. What the soul remembers decides how it drinks.

- ☐ **Inscribed in the Book**: kept and spoken. The soul crosses remembering what mattered most.
- ☐ **Forgotten**: lost to the river. The soul goes on, lighter and emptier, without it.
- ☐ **Never written** (still in the deck, a hand or the discard pile): never faced. Some things go across unsaid.

Then read the Book aloud, page by page. Even a lost crossing leaves a story: blanks read "...but this, the river has taken", and the epilogue tells how the soul was lost. Every game writes a different life.

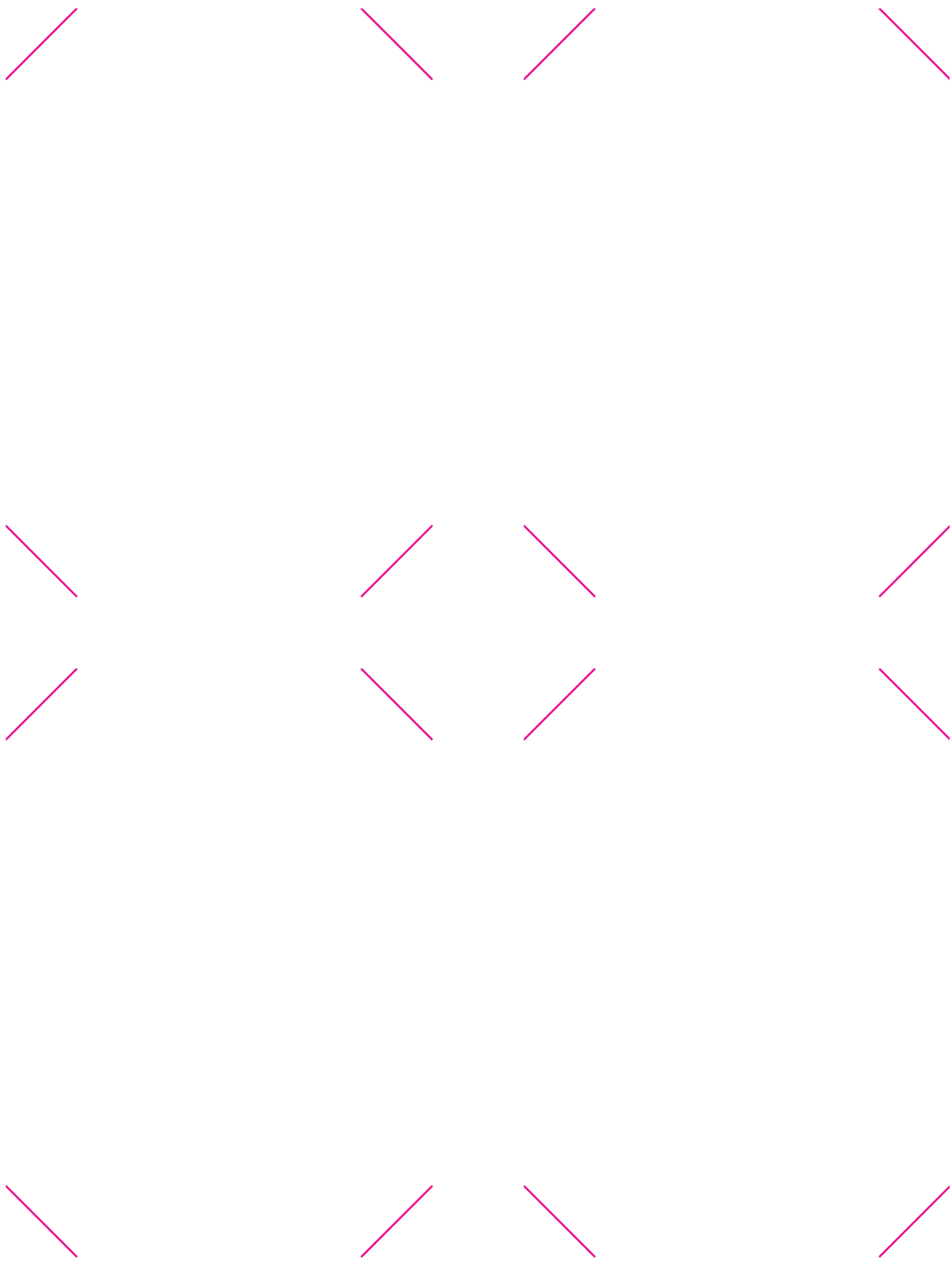
FERRYMEN _____ LANTERN _____ DATE _____





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RALPH LAUXIE



DIE LINE · pages 4–6 · photo-corner slits (magenta), 11 mm diagonals at each corner of the four 66 × 91 mm wells